

Researcher Guide

WRAC Research Funding Portal

Washington State Wine Commission — Research Advisory Committee

Website: <https://wrac-portal.vercel.app/>

How to register, submit proposals, and file reports.

What this portal is

This is where you apply to the Research Advisory Committee for research funding and manage your funded projects. You'll register once, submit proposals, and—if funded—file progress and final reports here. Your account carries over from year to year, so you register only once.

To begin, open <https://wrac-portal.vercel.app/> in any web browser on a computer, tablet, or phone.

Registering

Before you can apply, you create an account and the program manager approves it.

1. On the website, choose to sign up.
2. Enter your name, institution, email, and a password, and upload your current CV.
3. Submit. Your account is now **pending**—the program manager reviews new registrations.
4. Once approved, you can sign in and start applying. If your registration isn't approved, you'll see a message saying so.

While you wait

Approval isn't instant—it happens when the program manager reviews your registration. You'll be able to sign in, but you won't be able to submit anything until you're approved.

How applying works

Funding runs on an annual cycle, usually in two stages:

- **Pre-proposal** (typically mid-November) — a short outline of your idea. The committee reviews these and decides which are invited to go further.
- **Full proposal** (typically January) — if your pre-proposal is advanced, you're invited to submit a complete application with a budget.

Each stage has a deadline. Your dashboard shows what's open and when it's due.

Your dashboard

When you sign in, your home screen shows:

- **Cycles open for submission**—with their deadlines—and a button to start a pre-proposal.
- **Your proposals**—everything you've started or submitted, with its current status (Draft, Submitted, and so on).
- **Reports due**—if you have funded projects, any progress or final reports the manager has scheduled.

Submitting a pre-proposal

1. From your dashboard, find the open cycle and choose to start a pre-proposal.
2. Give your project a title, say how many years it will run, and enter an estimated amount for this year.
3. You're taken to the proposal's workspace. Upload the documents the manager has requested—each required document has its own slot.
4. You don't have to finish in one sitting. Your work saves as a **draft**; come back any time before the deadline.
5. When everything required is uploaded, review it and choose to submit.

Once you submit

A submitted proposal is **locked** so the committee can review a stable version. If you need to change something before the deadline, contact the program manager—they can reopen it for you. You can also **withdraw** (rescind) a proposal; it stays in your history but is no longer considered.

Deadlines

The submit button is only active while a cycle is open and its deadline hasn't passed. If you see "submission closed" on a draft, the window has passed or the cycle isn't accepting that type yet. The portal tells you exactly why. If you genuinely need to submit late, contact the program manager—they can allow it for your proposal.

Submitting a full proposal

If your pre-proposal is advanced, the program manager invites you to submit a full proposal. It appears on your dashboard as a new draft—you don't start it yourself.

1. Open the full-proposal draft from your dashboard.
2. Upload the full set of required documents (typically a fuller narrative, a budget, and your CV).
3. Fill in your **multi-year budget plan** if your project runs more than one year—an estimated amount for each year. Year one is what you're asking for now; the later years are your plan, which you'll formally request in future years.
4. Review and submit before the deadline.

Continuing a multi-year project

If you have a funded project that runs multiple years, you re-apply each year for that year's funding—multi-year projects aren't funded all at once. The program manager invites your **continuation request**, which appears on your dashboard (it skips the pre-proposal step).

When you open it, you'll see what you originally projected for this year next to the amount you're now requesting—your plans can change, and you can ask for a different amount than you first estimated. Upload the required documents and submit as usual.

Ending a project early

If you need to stop a project before it's finished, you can end it from the project in your dashboard. You'll be asked for a reason, and you'll then owe a final report.

Progress and final reports

Funded projects file reports during the work and a final report at the end. The program manager schedules these; each one appears in the **Reports due** area of your dashboard with its due date.

1. Open the report from your dashboard.
2. Write your narrative in the text box, and upload any required documents.
3. Your work saves as you go. When it's complete, submit it.

*A submitted report locks, like a proposal. If you need to correct it, ask the program manager to reopen it. Submitting your **final** report marks the project complete.*

Getting help

If something isn't working or you're unsure what's expected, contact the program manager—they can see your proposals and reports and can reopen anything you need to fix before a deadline.